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HUBSTARR LOGISTICS WORK INSTRUCTION		
	Subsystem/Office	
	Warehouse Operations	
Document Title		
Safe Use of a Bander (Manual and Electric)		

1.0 Scope

This work instruction applies to all HubStarr personnel who use a manual or handheld battery-operated electric bander with plastic (PP/PET) or metal (steel) strap.

2.0 Purpose

To prevent cuts and snap-back injuries by defining required PPE and safe banding steps.

3.0 Responsibility

- **3.1** Warehouse Personnel: Wear required PPE and follow this instruction.
- **3.2** Supervisors: Confirm operators are trained and tools and strap are correct.
- **3.3** Compliance Manager: Maintains this instruction and reviews incidents.

4.0 Definitions

- **4.1** Manual bander: Hand-powered tensioner, combination tool, or sealer.
- **4.2** Electric bander: Handheld, battery-operated tensioner. These tools do not weld the strap.
- **4.3** Plastic strap: Polypropylene (PP) or polyester (PET) banding.
- **4.4** Metal strap: Steel banding.

5.0 Instructions

5.1 Required PPE — put this on first

- **5.1.1** Safety glasses or goggles. Wear them the entire time you tension, seal, or cut strap.
- **5.1.2** Cut-resistant gloves. Plastic strap: minimum. Metal strap: minimum A4.
- **5.1.3** Closed-toe safety shoes. Tie back long hair. No loose jewelry near the tool.

5.2 Strap rules

- **5.2.1** Use only the strap type and width the tool is rated for. Do not mix plastic tools with metal strap, or metal tools with plastic strap.
- **5.2.2** Plastic strap: used on most cartons and pallets. Sealed with a buckle or seal. Do not reuse cut strap.
- **5.2.3** Metal strap: used on heavy loads only when specified. Sealed with a metal clip. Edges are sharp and snap-back is high. Do not reuse. Cut only with an approved steel-strap cutter. Stand clear of both ends when cutting.

5.3 Before you start

- **5.3.1** Inspect the bander. Tag it Out of Service if it is damaged, the battery is bad, a guard is missing, or it will not tension.
- **5.3.2** Inspect the strap. Do not use kinked, split, rusted, or crushed strap.

5.3.3 Keep others out of the line of the strap. Confirm the load is stable.

5.3.4 If you have not been shown this model, stop and ask a supervisor.

5.4 Band the load

5.4.1 Wrap the strap flat. Do not twist it.

5.4.2 Keep hands clear of the strap, tensioner, and sealer. Hold the grip only.

5.4.3 Tension only enough to secure the load.

5.4.4 Stand to the side while tensioning, sealing, or cutting. Do not stand in line with the strap.

5.4.5 Manual bander: tension with steady strokes. Do not yank the handle. Keep your off-hand off the tension wheel. Crimp the seal fully.

5.4.6 Electric bander: confirm the battery is seated. Hold the tool square and tension until the load is secure. These tools do not weld. Do not use them on metal strap unless the tool is built for steel.

5.4.7 Cut the tail with the tool cutter or an approved strap cutter. Never use a box cutter or pocket knife on tight strap. Tuck sharp tails.

5.5 After use

5.5.1 Return the bander to its designated spot. Charge batteries if needed.

5.5.2 Pick up scrap strap right away.

5.5.3 If the tool jammed or felt wrong, tag it Out of Service and tell a supervisor.

5.6 Never do this

5.6.1 Do not use a bander without eye protection and the correct gloves.

5.6.2 Do not put any body part under a tensioned strap.

5.6.3 Do not cut tight strap with a box cutter or by striking it.

5.6.4 Do not reuse cut strap or mix the wrong strap with the wrong tool.

5.6.5 Do not point the tool at anyone or horseplay with strap.

5.7 If something goes wrong

5.7.1 Injury: Stop work. Get first aid. Report it the same shift.

5.7.2 Snapped strap or near miss: Tell a supervisor. Do not keep using a tool that just failed.

5.7.3 If you are not sure the load, tool, or strap is right, stop and ask.

6.0 Verification

6.1 Supervisors confirm operators have been shown this instruction before first use.

6.2 Compliance Manager reviews this instruction annually or after an incident.